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From: Nicola Johnson <nicky.johnson@hotmail.com>
Sent: 20 June 2019 21:56
To: Nick WRM New
Subject: EDC letter

Emma Dent-Coad MP,
House of Commons,
London SW1A 0AA
emma.dentcoad.mp@parliament.uk
cc:
Heather Buchanan,
Director of Policy and Strategy,
All-Party Parliamentary Group on Fair Business Banking,
House of Commons,
London SW1A 0AA
heather.buchanan@appgbanking.org.uk

Dear Mrs Dent-Coad,

I am writing to you as your constituent. I live at 8 Addison Crescent, London W14 8JP.

I would be very grateful for your assistance in respect of a charge against my home, registered by Barclays Bank. I believe that the charge was improperly obtained by the bank and I would greatly appreciate your support, given that my family and I face the loss of the proceeds of sale of our home.

By way of background, in 2009 Barclays Bank granted "equity release" of some £12,000,000 to my former husband, Ziad Takieddine, in the form of loans secured against our then matrimonial homes in London and Paris. Barclays granted the loans against our jointly-owned family homes without my knowledge or consent and in the middle of controversial divorce proceedings. The bank knew that my husband had filed for divorce prior to the loans and that the purpose of the "equity release" was to defraud me and my former husband's other creditors, including the French government.

Barclays was fully aware that the loans facilitated my former husband's criminal fraud not only against me but also against the French state. It was public knowledge that he was under investigation in France for tax evasion, money-laundering and political corruption offences, offences for which he has been charged and for which he currently faces trial. I am a key witness and civil party to the French state's criminal prosecutions of Mr Takieddine and several French political figures. The trial will take place in October 2019 in Paris.

Barclays is named in these proceedings, in the context of what the prosecutors have described as the "*fraude massive*" (massive fraud) perpetrated by Mr Takieddine between 2007 and 2009. Barclays role included providing what the bank described as "*equity release*", enabling and assisting Mr Takieddine to transfer £12,000,000 of our matrimonial assets to remote offshore locations, beyond the reach of European justice.

Barclays knew who they were dealing with. Mr Takieddine was recognised by the bank from the outset as a Politically Exposed Person and Barclays will have considered the various contemporaneous press reports linking him to money-laundering, political corruption, tax evasion and other serious criminal offences. Nonetheless, Barclays conspired with Mr Takieddine to undertake a course of action designed to defraud me and his other creditors.

Barclays' motivation was commercial. The bank benefitted from unusually high loan fees of more than £400,000 paid to itself and its advisors. Furthermore, it appears from the bank's internal documents that Barclays was also seeking to profit from Mr Takieddine's links with the Libyan regime of Colonel Gaddafi. Barclays was at the time seeking a major equity investment from Libya to avoid the UK government bail-out.

The Libyan links desired by Barclays were far from reputable. Mr Takieddine has publicly admitted that he carried millions of euros of Gaddafi's cash from Libya to France to provide illegal financing for Nicolas Sarkozy's successful 2007 presidential campaign. Barclays also knew that by financing Mr Takieddine, the bank was helping to supply weapons to a convicted terrorist, Abdullah Senoussi, Gaddafi's brother-in-law and security chief, via an illegal arms contract studied and relied upon by Barclays. This contract has since been charged in France with complicity in acts of torture against Gaddafi's political opponents.

Mr Takieddine is also the subject of a UK arrest warrant, issued by Westminster Magistrates Court to face charges of perversion of the course of justice and conspiracy to pervert the course of justice in relation to his attempts to deprive me of my rights in respect of our matrimonial home in London. Most notably Mr Takieddine forged a share sale agreement to enable a company owned by him to issue possession proceedings against me 2010.
Mr Takieddine spent time in a French prison in 2013 for breaching bail conditions and has also been convicted three times in France for *"abandon de famille"* ("wilful neglect to maintain") for which he received a further prison sentence in 2014.
I am currently trying to sell my house but am being prevented from doing so by Barclays, which is refusing to agree to meet to discuss the controversial loans and has even refused to provide a mortgage redemption statement to my lawyers saying they will only do so when "a completion date is fixed." It is possible that the bank has lost or destroyed some of its records of its dealings with Mr Takieddine. But I think that the proper course of action is for the bank to admit to its wrongdoing and to try to make amends. I believe that the charge has no validity given the circumstances surrounding its creation. I would like to have the opportunity to discuss the matter with the Bank in the hope of either agreeing the way forward or at least, narrowing the issues in dispute. The Bank has refused to meet with me since I first contacted them in July 2018.
I hope that you will agree that Barclays has treated me and continues to treat me most unfairly. I would be very grateful for your support, for example via a letter to the Chairman of the bank, Sir Ian Cheshire requesting an appointment. The bank's registered address is 1 Churchill Place, London E14 5HP.
I am aware of the work done at the All-Party Parliamentary Group on Fair Business Banking and I would like to bring this matter to their attention. For this reason I am copying in Heather Buchanan, the APPG's Director of Policy and Strategy.
Thank you in advance for your help.
Yours sincerely,
Nicola Johnson
8 Addison Crescent
London W14 8JP

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